

As elsewhere, Edwards is using “necessary” to mean “something we don’t have any choice about.” What does it mean for two things to be **indissolubly** connected?

“3. It is also very manifest, that those things which are indissolubly connected with other things that are necessary, are themselves necessary.”

1. We have no choice about
past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.

3. We have no choice about God's knowing that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)





The idea is that the connection is not possible to break — it is, in terms familiar from the cosmological argument, a **necessary** connection.

Suppose that we have a situation in which, if A happens, then B necessarily follows.

Or, to put the same point a different way, suppose that it is impossible for A to happen and B not to happen. In that situation, we'll say that A **necessitates** B .

In these terms, we can put Edwards' thought from the above quote as follows:

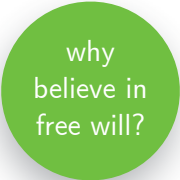
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X , we have no choice about X .



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

choice about.' What does it mean for two things to be indistinguishably connected?

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parasitiforms.

1. We have no idea about



for knowledge of future

acai.ios.

2. In the past, God had



3. We have no idea about

act in action (1,2)

the future I will perform

God's knowing that in

from the causal argument, a necessary connection.

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chicabonix.

4. If we have no idea about

some facts, and these facts

need estimates X , we have no

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

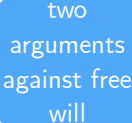
and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a



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argument might be related to an argument

for fatalsn.

first let's think about how Edwards'

responding to Edwards' argument. But

We'll shortly consider some ways of

there were truths about all our future

similar to Edwards' argument?

Suppose that someone did not believe in

actions. Could they give an argument

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

our future actions.

with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

God only shows up in premises (2) and



choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

acaioid.

all of our activities.

perform a certain action (1,2)

3 We have not at the fact that

0 We have achieved what we

1. We have no direct facts.

(3, 4, 5)

then we have the choice about q.



4. If we have no choice about p , and no

God knows that in the future I will

some action, then I will prefer that

5* We have not noticed the fact

will perform various actions.

that if it is true that I will perform

2* In the past, there were truths about

The fatalist argument

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.



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past facts.



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need, estimate X , we have no

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